

Pronunciation

B C D F G H J L M N P R S T V W Y

C = /k/ (cake) · H = /h/ or soft rasp · J = /dʒ/ (jello) · R = /r/ flap (American butter)

Vowels: A /ɑ/ (father) · E /ɛ/ (cellar) · I /i/ (creek) · O /ɔ/ (door) · U /u/ (flu)

E and O closed like Spanish are fine too.

Stress: penultimate syllable — iLlru

1. Pronouns and Possession

	singular	plural
1st	nim I	nima we
2nd	run you	runa you (pl)
3rd	hay he / she / they	haya they (pl)

Pronouns are often dropped when context is clear. Affirmative sentences default to nim, and questions to run, so you don't repeat them as much as in English.

Possessive: pronoun before the word · for nouns, use de

nim bo = my house
bo de miwo = dog's house

2. The Four Core Markers

a [subject] · i [verb] · e [direct object] · u [indirect object]

Mnemonics: Actor · Initiates · Engaged · Unto

a nim i anona e mocen u run
I give chocolate to you

More often (nim dropped in affirmative): i anona e mocen u run

You may drop markers when context is clear. a drops the easiest, and then e.

a...a means is / are:

a hay a yalen = he/she/they is tall · a bo a yamirli = the house is old

Word order is flexible because roles are marked: e mocen u run i anona is also common.

3. Describing Words

A modifier goes right before the word it describes.

mocen mouje = chocolate drink
pohem mocen mouje = hot chocolate drink

4. Two Core Prepositions

en = location / time ("in, on, at")

de = source / possession ("of, from")

a run en bo = you are at home
a hay i anifi de bo = he/she/they comes from the house

5. Coordination and Contrast

su	and / with	run i mo e moaria su mocen	you eat apple and chocolate
mai	but	hay i anvu, mai nim i doum	she goes, but I don't
dou	or	nim i mo e moaria dou mocen	I eat apple or chocolate
eta	so, therefore	a nim a tou, eta nim i bonfene	I'm tired, so I lie down

6. Negation

Add -um to the word you want to negate.

i dami a moaria = there is an apple
i damium a moaria = there is no apple

7. Questions and "what/that" Clauses

Raise intonation for yes/no questions. No structural change.

run i mo? = are you eating?

ce = what (question) · ca = that / which (connector)

ce en bo? = what's in the house?

Build more question words with ce + a domain word:

word	meaning
cei	who (what + person)
cedom	where (what + place)
celi	when (what + time)
ceora	why (what + reason)
cenon	how (what + way)

In statements, swap ce → ca: ceora → caora (because) · cedom → cadom (where) · etc.

run i ilianum cadom bo = you know-not where the house

8. Verb Stacking

To chain two verbs, repeat i before each one. No "to" needed.

run i dairan i anelem en bo = you like to stay home
hay i do i mo = he/she/they can eat
haya i dai i anvu = they want to go

9. Compounds

-a suffix bonds modifiers and noun into a single concept:

waa jasru	waa (sea) + jasru (bend)	= bay
lufua bei	lufua (air) + bei (vehicle)	= airplane
yalgaia mus	yalgaia (small) + mus (bug)	= ant
waa dom	waa (sea) + dom (land)	= island

Hyphenated forms fuse two words into one expression:

falen-li	falen (child) + li (time)	= childhood
tohpu-vanvu	tohpu (sad) + vanvu (walk)	= to trudge
bo-bortal	bo (house) + bortal (enter)	= to enter a house

If you're unsure which form to use, just use whatever feels right. Chances are, either works!

10. Vocabulary

Most Oravia words are formed as (sub)cluster + root. A cluster is the first sound(s) and signals the semantic domain; a root adds a second layer of meaning.

moalen (banana) = MO (food) + A (fruit subcluster) + LEN (root: long)

~260 (sub)clusters and roots were discovered using word-embeddings. Once you know the patterns, you can make educated guesses and learn words faster.

Starter Vocabulary

mo	eat / food	bo	house	beivu	car	leirih	tree
falen	child	fare	parent	faejor	woman	faejal	man
faibor	spouse	eofa	friend	elihei	person	anye	make, do
anvu	go	anona	give	anifou	need	ando	can
none	have	anidai	want	dami	exist	dairan	like
ilian	know	ilaluan	speak	elemi	live, life	yuba	good
ti	bad	yalen	tall/long	litam	day	liyar	morning
noli	now	noi	here / this	ho noi	there / that	oipoh	exciting

AN	action <i>PIE *h₂en- (to breathe/live)</i>	DUR	hardness <i>Latin durus (hard, tough)</i>	ILI	cognition <i>Portuguese/Spanish inteligencia (intellig...</i>
ANE	static movement <i>Latin manere (to remain/stay)</i>	ELA	religious <i>Aramaic Elah (God)</i>	ILO	when knowledge is uncertain <i>English illusion</i>
ANI	movement towards / directed... <i>Latin animus (directed will)</i>	ELE	self-expansion <i>Greek ἐλευθερος (eleutheros = free, self...</i>	IRAN	favor
ANO	movement away <i>Japanese ano (that, over there)</i>	ELI	virtue <i>Greek ἠθικός (ethikos = ethical)</i>	JA	tools <i>Arabic jihāz (apparatus, equipment)</i>
APA	physical movement <i>Sanskrit apad (to move on foot)</i>	ELO	prosocial <i>Latin eloqui (to speak out)</i>	JAE	container <i>Portuguese/Spanish/Arabic jarra (large c...</i>
AS	involuntary bodily functions <i>PIE *h₁es- (to be, to exist)</i>	EO	social <i>Greek εὖ- (eu = good, social prefix)</i>	JAH	cutting tools <i>Japanese (hajī = blade, edge)</i>
ASE	affectionate contact <i>Sanskrit āśleṣa (embrace, close contact)</i>	EOD	social interactions <i>Japanese deau (meet)</i>	JAS	gripping and fastening tools <i>Japanese hasamu (clamp, pinch)</i>
ASI	orifice intake and expulsion <i>Sanskrit āśya (mouth)</i>	EOM	events and gatherings <i>Korean moim (gathering, meeting)</i>	JE	geometrics <i>Mandarin (jié = joint, geometric section)</i>
ASU	involuntary vocal acts <i>Sanskrit asu (breath, vital force)</i>	FA	family relationships / family <i>Latin familia (family)</i>	JEN	location <i>Japanese (zen/jen front location)</i>
BE	travel <i>Bengali berano (to roam, travel)</i>	FAE	gender	JEO	geometric positions <i>Greek γεω- geo (geography, geometry)</i>
BEI	vehicles	FAI	partnership, marriage <i>Latin foedus (pact, partnership)</i>	JO	materials <i>Korean jaeryo (material)</i>
BO	home interior <i>Arabic (bayt = house, dwelling)</i>	FAL	young ones <i>Latin filia, filius (children)</i>	JOL	material types
BOE	house spaces <i>English bower (chamber, private room),...</i>	FE	halting <i>Turkish fren (brake)</i>	JU	deceive <i>Hindi jhūth (lie, deception)</i>
BON	furniture <i>French banc (bench, table-like furniture)</i>	FEI	less	JUI	temporary <i>Hindi/Urdu jugār (makeshift, temporary f...</i>
BOR	house structure <i>English bore/board (structural element)</i>	FENE	rest	LA	happiness <i>across unrelated languages as an expre...</i>
BOS	hygiene fixtures <i>Malay basuh (to wash)</i>	FI	inside <i>Swahili -fika (to arrive, come)</i>	LAN	balance <i>Hindi sāmtulana (balance, equilibrium)</i>
CAI	flat <i>Sanskrit caya (flat layer)</i>	FIVA	cold	LANO	around
CATI	constraint <i>Latin catena (chain, constraint)</i>	FOU	lack <i>English few</i>	LARO	continuation
CE	what? <i>Latin quid (what) and Romance que/ce</i>	FU	lightness <i>Mandarin fú (floating, light)</i>	LE	environment / area <i>PIE *lendh- (open land, heath)</i>
CI	sharp <i>Mandarin cǐ (to stab, prick, sharp)</i>	GA	evaluation <i>English gauge</i>	LEA	landscape <i>English lea (open meadow, landscape ty...</i>
CIU	creative products <i>English creative, Latin creatus (produced)</i>	GAI	small <i>English grain of sand</i>	LEI	plants <i>Mandarin (lěi = flower bud, plant growth)</i>
CO	communication <i>Latin communicare (to communicate)</i>	GALI	coffee <i>Arabic qahwa (coffee)</i>	LEM	keeping <i>Greek λήμμα lēmma (something taken a...</i>
COU	written communication <i>French courier (mail, correspondence)</i>	GAN	ranking <i>Japanese (kaku/gan proximity = rank, gr...</i>	LEN	long <i>Latin longus (long)</i>
DA	evaluation <i>Arabic dhā (this, that, referential)</i>	GAO	value assessment	LENO	ground <i>Spanish llano (flat ground)</i>
DAE	epistemic <i>Japanese (dai = declaration, evidence, p...</i>	GAR	bear	LEO	belonging
DAI	desire	GE	finances <i>Proto-Germanic *geldan (to pay)</i>	LI	time <i>Mandarin (lǐ (calendar)</i>
DAL	pattern <i>Swahili dalili (sign, indication, pattern)</i>	GEL	trading <i>German Geld/gelten (to be worth, to tra...</i>	LIA	resonant <i>Hindi laya (rhythm, resonance)</i>
DAN	emphasis <i>Mandarin (dàn = but, emphatic contrast)</i>	GI	boldness <i>Hindi jigar (courage, heart)</i>	LIL	muscle <i>Arabic lif (fiber)</i>
DAO	serious	GO	half <i>Japanese go (five, half of ten)</i>	LIMEL	evening <i>Arabic layl (night)</i>
DAU	distance	GOR	firm	LIRA	mark <i>Latin littera (letter, mark)</i>
DE	origin, from <i>Latin de (from, down from)</i>	HAI	message <i>Swahili habari (news, message)</i>	LITE	clock time <i>Greek λεπτό lepto (minute)</i>
DEL	logic <i>Latin delineare (to draw out logically)</i>	HE	fiction tropes <i>Greek ἥρως (heros = hero, trope figure)</i>	LIU	other <i>Latin allius (other)</i>
DETU	end	HEH	antagonist tropes <i>English hex</i>	LOA	completeness <i>Hawaiian loa (very much, extremely)</i>
DI	stripe, finger <i>Sanskrit diś (direction, to point)</i>	HEI	protagonist tropes / person <i>Mandarin hei (hey, exclamation used to...</i>	LU	weather and atmosphere / out... <i>Latin lux (light, sky phenomenon)</i>
DO	regulations <i>Mandarin (dào = way, rule, principle)</i>	HELA	projecting outward <i>Sanskrit hel (to throw, sport)</i>	LUA	flow <i>Arabic luja (deep flowing water)</i>
DOH	enforcement <i>Hausa dokar (regulation)</i>	HEM	warmth	LUAN	tongue <i>Arabic lisān (tongue)</i>
DOI	opposing <i>Arabic ʿidd (opposing, against)</i>	HEO	background <i>Old English heofon (firmament, vault of...</i>	LUFU	air <i>German Luft (air)</i>
DOM	place <i>Latin domus (house, place, domain)</i>	HOH	extreme	LUN	seasons <i>Latin luna (moon, seasonal cycle)</i>
DON	show	HOU	shadow <i>Mandarin hòu (behind, back)</i>	MA	cooking food / matter <i>Arabic (matbakh = kitchen)</i>
DORA	bond <i>Latin adorare (to be bound in devotion)</i>	HUE	haze	MAE	tubers and grains <i>Mandarin (mǐ = rice, grain)</i>
		HUI	ethereal <i>Mandarin hún (soul, spirit)</i>		
		IL	objects of inquiry <i>Latin ille (that thing, object of inquiry)</i>		
		ILA	sharing information <i>Arabic (ilā = toward, sharing direction)</i>		

● MAL	bread and dairy <i>German Mehl (flour)</i>	● RA	society <i>Sanskrit rastra (state, polity, society)</i>	● TOH	emotional suffering <i>English torment</i>
● MAS	spices and seasonings <i>Arabic (masāla = spice blend)</i>	● RAI	governance <i>Hindi (rāj = rule, governance)</i>	● TOS	interpersonal suffering <i>Greek pathos (suffering, passion)</i>
●● MI	bigger animals / existence, bei... <i>Swahili mnyama (animal, with m- animat...</i>	● RAM	sudden <i>Latin raptim (suddenly, rapidly)</i>	● TOU ● TU	physical depletion conflict <i>Latin tumultus (conflict, violent disorder)</i>
● MIA ● MIE	mixing appearance <i>Mandarin miàn (face, appearance)</i>	● RAN	media, public discourse <i>Hindi raṅgmanc (public stage)</i>	● TUL	crash <i>English tumble</i>
● MIN ● MIO	pleasure wild animals <i>Hindi mīṅ (wild animal)</i>	● RAS	about society <i>Arabic/Persian/Urdu rasm (social practic...</i>	● TUM	weapons <i>Indonesian tombak (spear/weapon)</i>
● MIR	lots of <i>Sanskrit mīr (leader of many)</i>	● REL	up, high <i>Latin relevare (to lift, raise up)</i>	● VA	core <i>Sanskrit (vāyu = vital wind/breath)</i>
● MIU ●● MO	support food, eating / eat <i>Hawaiian moku (to eat, archaic)</i>	● REN	honor <i>Mandarin rén (benevolence, honor)</i>	● VABO	cozy, body home <i>va (body) + bo (home)</i>
● MOA	fruits <i>Polynesian languages moa (banana plan...</i>	● REVA	accurate <i>Latin revelare (to reveal)</i>	● VAL	ice <i>Italian valanga (snow mass), English/Fre...</i>
● MOL ●● MU	food containers smaller animals / small animal <i>Swahili mduu (insect, bug)</i>	● RI ● RIH ●● RO	act higher, rising knowledge / thinking, reasoning <i>Japanese (ron = argument, theoretical k...</i>	● VAN	limbs <i>Hindi (bāṃh = arm/limb)</i>
● MUH	flying animals <i>Persian morgh (bird)</i>	● ROE	formal education <i>Latin rogare (formally proposing)</i>	●● VAR	face <i>Sanskrit vaktram (face/mouth)</i>
● NA	giving <i>Proto-Bantu *-nab-/*-na (to give)</i>	● ROU	written knowledge <i>Latin rotulus (scroll, written scroll)</i>	● VARI	back <i>Arabic warā (behind, back)</i>
● NALA	urgency <i>Arabic nafara (urgent flight, alarm)</i>	● RU	bend <i>Arabic rukū (bowing, bending)</i>	● VAS ● VEI	private health issues <i>Sanskrit vaidya (physician)</i>
●● NE	quantifiers <i>Swahili na (additive marker)</i>	● RUL	habit <i>English rule</i>	● VEL	medical treatments <i>Latin valere (to be well/healthy)</i>
● NEN	power and violence <i>Latin imponens (imposing)</i>	● SAR	hang <i>Turkish sarkmak (to hang down)</i>	● VER	safety <i>German Wehr (defense, protection)</i>
● NI	new <i>Hindi nayā (new)</i>	● SARI	sun <i>Sanskrit sūrya (sun)</i>	●● VI	interior body / internal body <i>Proto-Bantu *-vim- (becoming thick)</i>
● NIU	some <i>Tagalog niyon/niyun (that)</i>	● SAU	start <i>Hindi śūrū (start, beginning)</i>	● VIO	change, exchange <i>Latin via (road, path of change, exchange)</i>
●● NO	function words / downward, ex... <i>Latin non (negation, downward moveme...</i>	● SE	machines <i>Mandarin (shèbèi = equipment)</i>	●● VIR	organs / method <i>Sanskrit vṛt (to proceed, method, proced...</i>
● NON ● NOR	path relation to reference <i>Latin norma (standard, reference point)</i>	● SEL	coding <i>English select, cell</i>	● VOA	constraint <i>Mandarin wéi (enclose, surround)</i>
● NOU	low, falling <i>Arabic nawm (sleep, falling into sleep)</i>	● SEM	system <i>Greek σύστημα systema (system)</i>	● VON ● VOR	external body threat <i>English horror</i>
● NU	limit <i>Greek vu nu (particle marking limits in a...</i>	● SERI	series <i>Latin series (sequence, series)</i>	● VOS	cleaning actions <i>Vietnamese vỏ (cover, shell, skin)</i>
● NYA	empty <i>Sanskrit śūnya (nothingness, emptiness)</i>	● SI	processes <i>PIE *sek- (to follow a sequence, to proce...</i>	● VU	movement <i>Mandarin bù (step, pace)</i>
● ODU ● OI	top fun <i>Yiddish/English oy (exclamation of feeling)</i>	● SIO	games <i>Latin iocus (game, jest, play)</i>	● VUSON	slow movement <i>vu (move) + son</i>
● OM	music <i>Sanskrit om/aum (the primordial sound,...</i>	● SIU ● SOI	written record speed <i>Vietnamese sớm (soon, early)</i>	●● WA	water, sea / water <i>Polynesian root wai (water)</i>
● ORA ● PA	idea paper <i>Latin papyrus (paper)</i>	● SU ● TA	alongside hand <i>Latin tangere (to touch with hand)</i>	● WI	geographical orientation <i>Arabic (wayn = where?)</i>
● PAI	foot <i>Hindi pair (foot)</i>	● TAI	guide <i>Mandarin dài (lead)</i>	● WIL	human made geography <i>Latin villa (human settlement)</i>
● PAN ● PARO	achievement front <i>Latin pro/prae (in front of, before)</i>	● TAL	door <i>Persian tāq (arch, doorway)</i>	● WIM ● WOL ● WOWO ●● YA	natural geography wide back-and-forth motion objective qualities / represent... <i>Swahili -a (Bantu adjectival linker)</i>
● PILI ● PO	delicate components <i>English portion</i>	● TALE	passage <i>Welsh taith (journey, passage)</i>	● YAH ●● YAL	texture qualities size qualities <i>Arabic ṭawīl (long, tall, length)</i>
● POA	chemical <i>Mandarin (pào = bubble, chemical reacti...</i>	● TAM	one <i>Arabic tamām (whole, one complete)</i>	● YAR	light <i>Arabic ḍiyā (radiant light)</i>
●● POH	energy <i>Greek πῦρ (pyr = fire)</i>	● TAN	big <i>Greek titan (giant)</i>	● YE	clothing and fabric <i>Turkish yelken (sail/large expanse of fab...</i>
● POI ● POPO	liquids echo <i>onomatopoeia for hollow resonance/echo</i>	● TAR	regulate <i>Arabic tartīb (regulation, arrangement)</i>	● YEL	joining <i>English yoke</i>
● PU	loss, sadness <i>Persian pūc (emptiness, loss)</i>	● TEL	image <i>English television</i>	● YEN	printed <i>Mandarin yìn (stamp, print mark)</i>
● PUNI	command <i>Latin punire (to punish, command obedi...</i>	● TELI ● TER	moment count <i>Latin ter (three times)</i>	● YES ● YI ●● YO	garments sweet colors <i>Yoruba yọ (to emerge)</i>
● PUPI	water falling <i>onomatopoeia for falling water</i>	●● TI	harm, damage / bad <i>Tamil (tī = fire, harm, danger)</i>	● YOL ● YU ● YUN	sky and ocean subjective qualities personal characteristics
		● TIRA ● TIU	fungus types of harm <i>Sanskrit (tīva = severe, violent)</i>		
		●● TO	suffering, distress / suffering <i>Indonesian tobat (remorse, suffering fro...</i>		